

COUNCIL FOR THE CITY OF SCRANTON

HELD:

Tuesday, December 2nd, 2025

LOCATION:

COUNCIL CHAMBERS

Maria McCool, RPR
Official Court Reporter

C O U N C I L M E M B E R S :

GERALD SMURL - PRESIDENT

MARK MCANDREW, VICE PRESIDENT

JESSICA ROTHCHILD

THOMAS SCHUSTER

WILLIAM KING

FRANK VOLDENBERG, CITY CLERK

KATHY CARRERA, ASSISTANT CITY CLERK

THOMAS GILBRIDE, ESQ., COUNCIL SOLICITOR

(Pledge of Allegiance.)

MR. SMURL: Please remain standing for a moment of silent reflection for our service men and women throughout the world and for those who have passed away in our community, especially Jerry Gavin and Mary Jane Sheridan. Thank you. Roll call, please.

MS. CARRERA: Mr. King.

MR. KING: Here.

MS. CARRERA: Mr. Schuster.

MR. SCHUSTER: Present.

MS. CARRERA: Dr. Rothchild.

DR. ROTHCHILD: Here.

MS. CARRERA: Mr. McAndrew.

MR. MCANDREW: Present.

MS. CARRERA: Mr. Smurl.

MR. SMURL: Here. Dispense with the reading of the minutes.

MR. VOLDENBERG: THIRD ORDER.

3-A. SCRANTON CITY Planning
Commission RESOLUTION PASSED WITH A MAJORITY
VOTE RECOMMENDING THE ADOPTION OF THE 2025
ZONING ORDINANCE AMENDMENT AT THEIR MEETING
HELD NOVEMBER 19, 2025.

MS. HODOWANITZ: Joan Hodowanitz.

First I want to comment on the caucus we just had with Geisinger. As someone who gets their medical care through the VA in Wilkes-Barre, many times the VA has referred me to Geisinger either CMC or Mount Pleasant for various services which they could not provide in

1 Wilkes-Barre.

2 And the care I receive has always
3 been excellent. So I'm very dependent upon
4 them continuing to have the capability of
5 giving me first rate medical care. So in that
6 sense, I really do like Geisinger.

7 But I don't know, I just the last
8 couple weeks since this legislation has been
9 introduced, I have these red flags keep
10 flashing in my mind. One is the timing of this
11 legislation at the end of the year before there
12 is going to be a change in the makeup of City
13 Council and how votes might turn up next year
14 if this legislation came in January.

15 The other thing is just the whole
16 rationale they're giving for circumventing the
17 zoning board. It just doesn't sound right.
18 I'm not convinced, okay. They have nothing to
19 lose by approaching the zoning board first. I
20 don't know what's going on.

21 You know, so those red flags are
22 bothering me. And, you know, I have an evil
23 mind. Maybe it's because I was in the military
24 for so long and saw conspiracies, you know,
25 those blankety blank Russians and soviets and

1 all of these people.

2 But what I want to know is next year
3 when the Mayor is running for Congress and I
4 assume she intends to do that and she releases
5 her financial statements, are we going to see
6 Geisinger as a major contributor to her
7 campaign, you know, because I don't know, you
8 know, she's pushing this.

9 And that's her right to do as the
10 Mayor. But it could have taken a whole
11 different track. And I'm getting a very uneasy
12 feeling. But that's just me and my evil mind.
13 So we'll see because those documents will be
14 available if she does run for Congress next
15 year. Any progress on the collective
16 bargaining agreement for the DPW?

17 MR. SMURL: No comment made to me.

18 MS. HODOWANITZ: You know, we're
19 coming up on one year. December 31st will be
20 one year since they have no contract. How
21 about a director for DPW? I saw in 5-F about,
22 you know, when you have a vacancy in a
23 department head and how you're going to, you
24 know, put people in there and how long and 35
25 days.

1 And also, who replaces the Mayor
2 should she drop dead or get elected to
3 Congress? So it will be interesting to see who
4 among you becomes or the new people coming in
5 who becomes the President of City Council.
6 We'll have to watch that one very closely. Why
7 was 5-F removed? You said it was being removed
8 and not being introduced. What was the reason?

9 MR. SMURL: We had a lot of issues
10 with it, the entire Council did.

11 MS. HODOWANITZ: Okay, so it may
12 come forward in the new year.

13 MR. SMURL: In the new year it may.

14 MS. HODOWANITZ: Okay. Some of the
15 other things, 5-I, about buying Fidelity Bank;
16 one of the reasons was it was going to provide
17 a real time crime center.

18 What in God's name is a Real Time
19 Crime Center? I mean, is that where people go
20 to say I've been robbed? If you could --

21 MR. SMURL: No, when Chief Carroll
22 was here, he did explain all of that.

23 MS. HODOWANITZ: You can't hear him
24 in the back though.

25 MR. SMURL: Oh, okay. Well --

1 MS. HODOWANITZ: Anyway, in Fifth
2 Order you could explain that. I assume that,
3 you know, you presuppose you could find a
4 parking space to get to the Real Time Crime
5 Center. The Architectural and Urban Review
6 Commission, five residents knowledgeable and
7 interested in the preservation in historic
8 districts. What are the qualifications for
9 that?

10 We're looking for architects or just
11 people who say I love downtown Scranton.
12 Again, that is pretty vague to me. What are
13 the qualifications to sit on that commission?
14 Thank you. You have a great night.

15 MR. SMURL: Thank you, Joan. Gene
16 Barrett.

17 MR. BARRETT: Good evening. I'm
18 here to talk about the hospital in particular,
19 but let everybody understand that none of the
20 neighbors or I know anyone in this audience is
21 opposed to better healthcare, absolutely not.

22 All right. We don't want to be
23 perceived as obstructionists or
24 counter-progressive, etc. All we want is fair
25 treatment, nothing more and nothing less.

1 We had a meeting last night with the
2 hospital. It was a relatively productive
3 meeting and we discussed different issues about
4 the project in itself and the concerns of the
5 neighbors and so on. And obviously, one of the
6 major things is the height consideration.

7 I don't remember any -- settlement
8 on the 75 feet. There was discussion let's say
9 on 60 feet and so on. The community benefits
10 approach is something that we see as an
11 opportunity to create a -- kind of a
12 compromise, a mediation between all the parties
13 including the city, the hospital, the neighbors
14 and so on.

15 So I know Attorney Scacchitti
16 couldn't be here tonight. He has written a
17 letter, you know, to the hospital in regards to
18 last night's meeting and some of the
19 discussion, which seem to be headed towards not
20 a settlement but an understanding of how we
21 could reach an agreement or a settlement or
22 mediation, whatever you want to call it that
23 everyone is satisfied.

24 No one wins in these things.
25 Someone loses something. Someone wins

1 something and so on. We've all been through
2 that before. But that's where we are
3 attempting to do at this particular point in
4 time. The problem with that is the time
5 constraint.

6 The community benefit approach
7 cannot necessarily -- it can't be accomplished
8 in the timeframe as far as you're -- what
9 you're attaining -- considering legislatively.
10 So that's the problem right now.

11 So we've asked -- basically asked
12 the hospital to kind of back off somewhat to
13 give us time, all the parties to come to some
14 favorable conclusion for all of us. And then
15 the other thing that I spoke about last night
16 and I'll try to complete this as quickly as
17 possible is from logistics standpoint, all
18 right?

19 Having been in military intelligence
20 in the Army, all right, logistics was
21 important. You not only in an order of battle
22 that you reported as an analyst, you not only
23 needed to know what they had and then what you
24 have, okay, but you also needed to know if they
25 were going to leave how are they going to leave

1 and if you were going to leave the battle, how
2 were you going to leave and all of those
3 logistics that go into that particular
4 situation.

5 Currently right now, the traffic up
6 at that hospital is absolute bedlam. All
7 right. You come into a pinch point in the 1800
8 block of Mulberry Street. You've got cars on
9 both sides. You've got transport vans. You
10 got people dropping off other people.

11 You got handicap people coming off.
12 You've got Wayne County -- doesn't matter, St.
13 Mary's Villa, all day long traffic, traffic,
14 traffic. And it's just -- it's just an
15 absolute mess. So adding more services to the
16 situation, I just don't know how they're going
17 to do it.

18 Nay Aug Park is constantly busy.
19 Thanks to Council President Smurl and a group
20 of volunteers up there, they've done a
21 tremendous job. The park is much more busier
22 than it ever has been. The pool is now open in
23 the spring of 2026.

24 All right. We have ethnic
25 festivals. We have races. We have

1 fundraisers. The list goes on and on. The
2 hospital has constantly delivery of goods and
3 services, tractor-trailers. The tractor itself
4 is the tractor -- that's the truck.

5 Mr. Bolus will know himself, the
6 trailer is typically 53 feet long. All right.
7 If you could see them trying to come off of
8 Mulberry Street making that turn on -- or
9 Harrison Avenue making that turn up Mulberry
10 Street to get to there -- and then the area
11 that they have to get into in the 300 block of
12 Colfax it's just -- it's just a mess, constant
13 vehicles, constant construction.

14 It goes on and on. So it just seems
15 to me -- I just don't know logistically if
16 there is additional services added up there how
17 all of that is going to work. It's going to be
18 absolute bedlam. So that needs to be thought
19 about and looked at which doesn't seem to be in
20 the forefront of discussion at this particular
21 point in time. Thank you.

22 MR. SMURL: Thank you, Mr. Barrett.
23 Mike Mancini.

24 MR. MANCINI: Good evening,
25 Scranton. When you really care about something

1 you're critical of its success and hope for the
2 best. What brings me here weekly is the
3 citizens of Scranton. I know the kindness of
4 our hometown.

5 Tonight I will once again talk about
6 safety and the current climate. For months I
7 made Council and our citizens aware of issues
8 involving our safety. For months no one chose
9 to and I quote, "engage me," until last week.

10 Never expected to have a back and
11 forth with any of you regarding the safety of
12 our citizens other than getting our concerns
13 addressed. I've spoken before Council about
14 10,072 charged in the last five years with only
15 1,982 arrested.

16 We're talking about drugs, guns,
17 gang, simple and aggravated assaults, rape,
18 robberies, thefts, unwanted opioid-related
19 deaths. There are well over 2,000 warrants
20 issued for unruly individuals that have not
21 been addressed.

22 Our current climate cannot be pick
23 and choose. Last week Mr. McAndrew and I had a
24 back and forth without resolving my concerns.
25 He stated that it was not in his purview to

1 even question my concerns.

2 As the Chair for Public Safety, Mr.
3 McAndrew, since you're receiving a raise next
4 year, you may as well know about your
5 functions and responsibilities. One of them
6 according to the Home Rule Charter states that
7 you serve as a visible point of contact on
8 Council for residents who have concerns about
9 crime, traffic safety, or emergency response
10 bringing those concerns in the Council
11 deliberations.

12 Another is to provide legislative
13 oversight and how public safety policies are
14 implemented including asking questions and
15 requesting information from relevant city
16 departments during meetings.

17 My concerns are well within your
18 purview. Mr. McAndrew, you mentioned last week
19 that I spoke with Chief Carroll. That's fake
20 news. I have not spoken with him regarding any
21 of my concerns. I have asked you and the rest
22 of Council.

23 You mentioned that the District
24 Attorney prosecutes them and our police
25 department arrests them. Warrants are issued.

1 We have over 2,000 just sitting. That does not
2 sound safe to me. As a refresher, once again,
3 here are my concerns.

4 Where's the breakdown with the
5 police department as to why not one family
6 locally received justice over a loved one's
7 opioid-related death? What is the current
8 process of taking bad warrant -- sorry, strike
9 that -- taking active warrant, bad actors off
10 of our streets and making them safer?

11 How many warrants are active?
12 What's the difference between the former drug
13 task force and the concern structure? Are
14 there less officers specific to drug related
15 crimes? When is next unhoused task force
16 meeting?

17 I would like to know the drug
18 addiction prevalence rate and the provisional
19 drug overdose death rate for the last five
20 years. Other municipalities throughout the
21 country publish those numbers. Our citizens
22 need to know.

23 Scranton does not publish those
24 numbers. As the Chair for Public Safety, Mr.
25 McAndrew, I believe it's important that you

1 know firsthand what our city is currently
2 dealing with personally and looking for those
3 answers.

4 I will try to work to find ways to
5 better our current crime climate. I know the
6 word impact. And I know what it feels like.
7 You could count once again on two hands day of
8 sentencing for the person who took my son's
9 life.

10 I politely ask once again if you
11 would please let Mr. Voldenberg forward my
12 questions to both the Police Chief and
13 administration. Once they are returned, share
14 them with our citizens and then together we
15 could find ways to resolve our concerns.

16 More than likely, we have a railway
17 system coming in 2028. We need to become
18 proactive. If my concerns are not addressed
19 once again, I will become reactive.

20 I will redefine the word filibuster.
21 I will have speakers here every five minutes
22 until 1 a.m. One way or another, the concerns
23 and the safety of our citizens will be
24 addressed.

25 MR. SMURL: Mr. Mancini, what you're

1 asking for is a bunch of documentation.

2 MR. MANCINI: I'm not asking for
3 documentation. I'm not asking for specifics.
4 I just want the questions addressed --

5 MR. SMURL: You want the numbers.
6 You want the numbers.

7 MR. MANCINI: -- however they bring
8 them back. If they're not within the purview
9 or they need to be reasked or changed a little
10 bit, please do that.

11 MR. SMURL: Well, if you want all of
12 that information, you could send a right to
13 know into the police department. That's --
14 they have the stats. City Council does not
15 have that.

16 MR. MANCINI: City Council could ask
17 that, correct?

18 MR. SMURL: Ask for the
19 documentation?

20 MR. MANCINI: I've been here for
21 months talking about the safety of our city. I
22 have tried to have these questions addressed,
23 like the unhoused task force. Simple question,
24 when is the next meeting?

25 DR. ROTHCHILD: I have not been made

1 aware of the next meeting yet. I don't have a
2 date to give you. When I get notified, I'll
3 let you know, okay?

4 MR. SMURL: Thank you.

5 MR. MANCINI: In advance. Is
6 anybody going to ask Mr. Voldenberg or do I
7 have to start a filibuster?

8 MR. MCANDREW: Here. Here's the
9 answer to your questions from last week.

10 MR. SMURL: Bob Bolus.

11 MR. MANCINI: Thank you, Mark.

12 MR. BOLUS: Good evening, Bob Bolus,
13 Scranton. First off, I would like to ask if we
14 could have a moment of silence out of respect
15 to our National Guard Troops that were shot in
16 DC and the young lady whose life was taken by
17 an illegal that executed her right on the
18 street if we could go and remember and forget
19 what our troops really do do. I would just
20 like a moment, if we can.

21 MR. SMURL: Absolutely.

22 MR. BOLUS: Thank you. We got to
23 look at the illegals that have come here. And
24 we got to thank Biden for bringing them. And
25 how do we honor Biden when he looked at his

1 watch, saw our guys coming back from
2 Afghanistan in flag draped coffins, and all he
3 did was look at his damn watch.

4 He couldn't even salute them. And
5 yet, this city honors him with Biden Street,
6 signs on 81. It's a slap in all of our faces
7 that we're there when this guy allowed how many
8 illegals into our country that are raping our
9 women, murdering our people.

10 And what do they do? They sit in
11 jail for 20 years because we have a system?
12 They should be immediately executed like they
13 would be in any other country.

14 You know, when I sat here and
15 started listening to some of this -- and I
16 support what Gene had said without me
17 reiterating what he did, he's right on point
18 about the trucks and everything else and the
19 traffic, etc.

20 The expansion is ridiculous. We
21 have two other hospitals here that are starving
22 and screaming for help. And we've ignored
23 them. We're looking at people to buy them.
24 The hell with who wants to buy them. Make them
25 employee owned. Simple as that.

1 And put the money behind them from
2 Flynn and everybody else that's out here
3 throwing money all over the place. Put the
4 money behind the employees of those two
5 hospitals and give them the life that they
6 need.

7 We don't need a monopoly that we're
8 getting here with Geisinger. They might as
9 well buy the whole damn city between them and
10 the university. And we're sitting here like
11 idiots letting them do it.

12 As far as the purchase of this
13 building next door, that's about the most
14 asinine thing I've seen since I've been coming
15 here. It has zero purpose for what we want to
16 do. There is parking inside there for a few
17 employees.

18 But who else comes to visit it?
19 Park in the parking garage, walk up in a
20 snowstorm, park somewhere else and try and walk
21 here and there, it has zero purpose, none
22 whatsoever. And they'll prove that tonight is
23 ludicrous and screwing the people in this city
24 because it's a dumb project.

25 You let the one go by that was the

1 credit union that had parking and everything
2 else. That was a project. That was something
3 that should have been bought. City vehicles
4 should be converted to natural gas and cut our
5 expenses way down.

6 I want to make -- I donated 600
7 cooked turkeys and turkey breast to the
8 veterans, our fellow veterans in Berwick,
9 Pennsylvania for Thanksgiving so they had a
10 meal to eat. I want everybody to understand
11 out here my dinner is going to go on the 32nd
12 year I'm doing my all day Christmas buffet at
13 St. Pat's, All Saints Academy.

14 I just had 15,000 pounds of cooked
15 turkey breast come in through Plainville Turkey
16 Farms. And I want everybody to know it's open
17 to anyone that doesn't want to be home alone on
18 Christmas.

19 And I'm starting that today because
20 we got a long way down the road. But my
21 phone's been ringing like crazy, just show up
22 if you don't want to be home alone on
23 Christmas. You get an all day buffet. And you
24 get a takeout when you go home. So just show
25 up. Don't call and ask if the dinner is on.

1 It's on. And you're hearing that tonight.

2 And it's what we do and everybody
3 else that helps. And as far as this city or
4 the hospital project goes, it should be
5 shelved. And the university should be
6 curtailed on all the stuff they're buying and
7 they're tax exempt. Start giving the people in
8 the city the benefit of making them pay their
9 damn taxes and cut our taxes. Thank you.

10 MR. SMURL: Thank you. Lee Morgan.

11 MR. MORGAN: Good morning -- I mean,
12 good afternoon, Council. The first thing I'd
13 like to talk about today is that, you know, I
14 walked here and we're still having a discussion
15 about this hospital project.

16 I just don't seem to understand how
17 Council itself and the Mayor can't understand
18 that the hospital, CMC, even though they give
19 good care is antiquated. Expansion of
20 something that lacks the technology and the
21 equipment necessary for modern medicine needs
22 to come to Scranton.

23 Now, I had a health episode a couple
24 years ago where I was almost dead, went to
25 Regional. They couldn't do the job. I had to

1 go to the University of Pennsylvania. Dr.
2 Cevalasco was my doctor. And I had my procedure
3 there. And I'm standing here in front of you.

4 My chance of survival at Regional
5 were almost zero. The doctor there looked at
6 me and said, boy, are you healthy. We're going
7 to take you in and operate on you. So I came
8 back from there. But I had that followup care.

9 So I had to go to the CMC. And I'll
10 acknowledge that they gave me very good care.
11 But they were extremely antiquated. It's not a
12 condemnation of the CMC. It's a condemnation
13 of the government that we have here that you're
14 even envisioning a project like that when the
15 real answer here -- and I don't care what the
16 neighbors think because they have as much
17 knowledge as you have, which is none.

18 And I don't think you're looking for
19 any and you should be because the residents
20 deserve quality healthcare and Geisinger can't
21 deliver it because they are working in an
22 antiquated hospital with antiquated equipment
23 and the whole thing.

24 It's not that their doctors aren't
25 qualified and that they don't do the best job

1 they can. The other thing is, that hospital is
2 overwhelmed -- I mean overwhelmed. Just go up
3 there some night and walk into the emergency
4 room, see how that is functioning. It's just
5 brutal.

6 That's the only word I could tell
7 you. And I'm not telling you that they are not
8 trying to deal with it. I just think you guys
9 are in fantasy land. I think that the people
10 that gave this presentation today are in the
11 same land as you are because it's not about
12 expansion and making money. That's not what
13 healthcare is about.

14 It's about delivering care. And you
15 don't have a clue. And the people that sat at
16 this table, they don't have one either because
17 they're trying to get a project done. We need
18 a hospital built across from the Veterans
19 Center. Why, because when people have an
20 emergency, they need to get there fast.

21 They need to have access to where
22 they're going, okay? So if they're coming down
23 the expressway, they're getting there. And if
24 they're coming from the other direction, they
25 come down through Cedar Avenue.

1 You could make a corridor to that
2 hospital if you care to do that. But you know
3 what it could would take? Thought. And you're
4 just not cable and neither is the Mayor and
5 that's the problem.

6 And you got to ask yourself, where
7 is the State Senator and our State
8 Representative? Okay, just -- it's just
9 ridiculous what you're talking about here. Did
10 you ever think that one of you should pick up a
11 phone or an ink pen and write your State
12 Senator and write your State Representative?

13 I've written to every representative
14 in Washington over ECTV. And I'm getting ready
15 to do this -- Judge Kavanaugh on the Supreme
16 Court because I might have a little problem
17 with this Judge Bloom that's on this case. And
18 I've explained to him the case law that he's
19 trying to use says that he can't do it.

20 So we're going to have a little
21 disagreement. But in the end, I'm going to win
22 that one. Okay, I don't care if I'm a truck
23 driver or not; but somebody here has to start
24 thinking.

25 Okay, somebody has to say to

1 somebody instead of putting 10 million dollars
2 in a project and naming a pocket park after
3 Mayor Doherty who looted the city, maybe it's
4 time to put 10 million or 100 million dollars
5 or take a bond issue and build a hospital and
6 say to Regional, Moses Taylor or the CMC, this
7 is what we want and can you deliver?

8 You said -- you said here at the
9 meeting you have developers here. Well, use
10 one and build a hospital. Use eminent domain
11 and take the property you need, whether it's
12 Dunkin Donuts or whoever's property is across
13 from that bridge and start the project and move
14 a project forward in this city that meets the
15 needs of the community and the outlying
16 community.

17 CMC can't do that because they're
18 landlocked. They're antiquated. You know, a
19 modern hospital, people don't clean the
20 operating room, a robot does. In a modern
21 hospital, there's a nurses' station outside of
22 every so many rooms, not down the hallway.
23 It's totally different. You can't understand
24 that. Thank you.

25 MR. SMURL: Thank you. Ryan

1 Barrett.

2 MR. BARRETT: Good evening, how do
3 you do? My name is Ryan Barrett. I'm a
4 resident of the city. I was raised here. But
5 I was out of the city for about 17 years. But
6 about 10 years ago I moved my wife and, you
7 know, family back here.

8 We're both professionals. My wife
9 isn't from here. And there's many times that I
10 truly regret that decision. And this hospital
11 issue is exactly one of those reasons. Again,
12 my father and mother are still on the 400 block
13 of Arthur Avenue.

14 And in my whole life I've never
15 understood why that hospital is shoehorned into
16 a residential neighborhood of high income
17 taxpayers with nice properties, stable
18 families. It makes no sense that that hospital
19 is in that neighborhood.

20 And then you're up against the park
21 which has its own restrictions, zoning
22 restrictions. There's events. There's car
23 shows and concerts and festivals. And they
24 want to put a NIC Unit there or they want -- it
25 doesn't make any sense.

1 And then logistically like the
2 gentleman just talked about, it's not
3 accessible. It's poorly located within the
4 city. It's not accessible to the interstate
5 system. So it doesn't make any sense for the
6 city. It doesn't make any sense for the
7 residents.

8 And most of all, it doesn't make any
9 sense for Geisinger. It's a bad, bad idea
10 especially when we have a downtown that's
11 starving for development that could support a
12 hospital with business, restaurants, hotels,
13 gas stations.

14 And then again, if you're downtown,
15 you have access to the interstate system. You
16 are more centrally located for the residents.
17 And then finally if you are downtown, you don't
18 have to deal with the residents -- or property
19 owners. It's not a residential neighborhood.

20 So this is a terrible, terrible idea
21 to put that hospital and to expand into a place
22 where you can't expand. And again, the
23 healthcare system is moving away from all of
24 this.

25 Geisinger is owned by Kaiser

1 Permanente who is based in Oakland, California.
2 I and my wife lived in San Francisco. I
3 received my law degree out there. My wife was
4 a teacher out in Oakland. Believe me when I
5 tell you, they do not know where Pennsylvania
6 is let alone this little berg called Scranton.

7 And if this project comes across
8 somebody's desk and they take a look at this,
9 they're going to say pull the plug on this.
10 What are we doing here? Do you want to know
11 who is going to be left holding the bag,
12 Scranton as always and the residents.

13 And you're going to sacrifice these
14 residents for a terrible idea. Go downtown.
15 If there is anybody from Geisinger, I think
16 they're all gone. Do yourselves a favor, don't
17 go through with this plan, please. Next
18 Tuesday vote against this. It's a terrible
19 idea. Thank you.

20 MR. SMURL: Thank you. That's all
21 for the sign-in sheet. Anybody else wish to
22 address Council?

23 MR. HAILSTONE: Good evening. I'm
24 Jamie Hailstone. I'm General Counsel of
25 Lackawanna College. I was asked to come

1 tonight and express the support on behalf of
2 Lackawanna College for the zoning change.

3 Lackawanna College has recognized
4 that this particular zoning change is about
5 progress. It's about changing the landscape of
6 medical care in our community. And we are
7 desperate for it and employers look for it.
8 People moving to the area look for these kind
9 of things.

10 The college supports it 100 percent
11 because the college believes that this is about
12 progress. This is about moving forward. I
13 appreciate your time. Thank you.

14 MS. KOLOSKI: Doris Koloski,
15 Scranton resident. All right. I agree mostly
16 what I was going to talk about was going to be
17 traffic, but Gene already covered that and the
18 other man that came after him covered it. I
19 wanted to talk a little about the inclusiveness
20 of the neighbors.

21 I heard tonight that this -- this
22 has been in discussion for, like, 18 months.
23 But the neighbors found out about that by
24 reading the newspaper just last month. If we
25 knew 18 months ago that this was -- this kind

1 of thing was going to come up, maybe we would
2 have a little bit more time to sit with the
3 hospital people and work out one of those good
4 neighbor agreements or come to a better
5 compromise.

6 But this has just been rushed and
7 push through and had no transparency and
8 nothing to do with the neighbors. Trust
9 issues, trust issues is the biggest thing
10 because we've been going through this round and
11 round.

12 First we had one CEO that said they
13 were going to put an office building over there
14 with underground parking. Then we heard, oh,
15 no, that guy is gone now. And we're going to
16 put two big parking garages 100 feet on the 200
17 block and the 400 block. Now they're gone and
18 this CEO says, well, now we're going to do it
19 this way.

20 Once you pass this bill for 100
21 feet -- and civic was just created this last
22 time when you did the SAPA. It was just
23 created. Before there was no civic. And then
24 you said now that you gave it to two other
25 hospitals.

1 So if that's the case, once you give
2 them 100 feet and if they can't go for a
3 variance, maybe they should create another
4 zoning that says you can't go more than 60
5 feet. We have no legs to stand on. We have no
6 recourse.

7 Once this 100 feet is granted,
8 anything they say, they could change their
9 mind. And it's not just the height. And it's
10 not just the traffic. It's the other things
11 that you could do within the civic zoning that
12 they may want to do.

13 They may decide, okay, we want to
14 put another heliport up. And it might land
15 right on top of that hospital that's going to
16 be right across the street from my house. They
17 don't even do a lot of the small things you ask
18 them to do.

19 They took away the ashtray that was
20 by the bus place where the people just stand
21 there and smoke while they're waiting for their
22 bus. The butts grow in our -- they blow in our
23 lawns when we have a big windy day. And we
24 have to go out there and pick up the butts.

25 I asked Nick at one of the meetings

1 about that ashtray, can't they put it back. He
2 said, okay, they will. That was, what, almost
3 a month ago. There is nothing there now.

4 I had asked the hospital when they
5 made the garbage dump across the street from my
6 house with all the big trailers that they would
7 come over from the hospital and they just throw
8 the stuff in and it would go bang, bang, bang.

9 And I'd say to them, can't you put
10 one of those noise screens there so we don't
11 have to listen to it? No, we can't. That was
12 it. So when they do put that part over there,
13 where are they going to put their garbage dump?

14 Are they going to put it behind my
15 house because they bought the house behind my
16 house. Am I going to have to hear it back
17 there? Am I going have to smell it back there?
18 This is -- these are the things we want to
19 know.

20 Maybe they're going to move them all
21 the garbage dump over to the 200 block and they
22 could deal with it over there. I don't know.
23 I have no clue what they're planning on doing.
24 But it's very upsetting that they say they want
25 to include us and they did speak to us

1 yesterday.

2 But there is time constraints and
3 nobody seems to care about that. You want to
4 vote on all of this on the ninth. So you are
5 not giving us enough time to discuss further
6 with the hospital and maybe come to something
7 more agreeable for both of us. Thank you for
8 your time.

9 MR. SMURL: Thank you, Doris.

10 MR. HOPPEL: Good evening. My name
11 is Tom Hoppel. And I'm at the 200 block of
12 Arthur avenue, 215 Arthur Avenue.

13 MR. KING: Mr. Hoppel, can you move
14 the mic up a little?

15 MR. HOPPEL: Yes, absolutely.

16 MR. KING: Thank you.

17 MR. HOPPEL: Okay. And thank you
18 very much for your time and interest in this
19 project. I mean, everybody agrees on
20 healthcare in Scranton and advances and that.
21 What I'm concerned about is the size of the
22 project, the height of the project.

23 The way it seems to me and I'm a
24 layman, but so to turn the 200 block of Colfax
25 into civic and five years from now they decide

1 they want a project, they have 100 back there
2 to play with. So that is what you need zoning
3 for.

4 And, I mean, much smarter people
5 than me about this know that that, you know,
6 these people are brand new. I mean, they're --
7 they haven't come to you guys before, have
8 they? So you guys change. But the neighbors
9 stay there.

10 You know we -- we're -- I could see
11 in five years, oh, we decide we want a parking
12 garage. We have 100 feet back there. And
13 that's right behind my house. And that would
14 really surround my house because on Linden
15 Street, I'm surrounded by a very big
16 unattractive building and sort of the back of
17 the hospital where all the trucks come in.

18 The heliport is right half a block
19 from my house. So I get a lot of beeping and
20 helicopters pretty frequently. I'm okay with
21 that. I mean, we're in a city. And I'm not
22 saying that, you know, we should, you know, not
23 be good neighbors too and be respectful of the
24 important role that the hospital does serve for
25 the community.

1 But to me, it seems like in five
2 years with no plan to use the 200 block, they
3 are saying, oh, let's just throw that in. I
4 think last night in the meeting with CPMC
5 officials, they said that that was sort of
6 afterthought that was actually a suggestion of
7 the Mayor to -- since we're doing this, to go
8 ahead and change that to civic with no plan,
9 absolutely no plan other than a vague maybe we
10 need it for parking in the future.

11 So, I mean, I've seen what they do
12 with these parking garages. There's one
13 between Linden Street and Mulberry. It's an
14 eyesore and not just during the day. At night
15 it's like the lights are blaring all night long
16 and it's eight stories. And that would be
17 dwarfed height what they could possibly put in
18 there.

19 So, you know, that's my -- my two
20 cents on this as a neighbor. There's a lot of
21 people here that have been struggling with this
22 and they are really frustrated. You know, CPMC
23 is a great institution. But also, you know,
24 there really is a vague plan here.

25 You know, there's not really, you

1 know, you're going to give them carte blanche
2 and I just don't understand that at all. I
3 don't think it's fair to the neighbors. You're
4 going to civic and saying, okay, 100 feet is
5 fine.

6 I mean, in five years, are they
7 going to say, oh, well, by the way, they agreed
8 to 75 feet or 65 feet or 60 feet. I think the
9 number that was tossed around by the neighbors
10 was 60 feet. And I thought that last night
11 CPMC was agreeable to that.

12 So anyway -- and they were also --
13 it seemed like they were agreeable to
14 scratching any development or any change to
15 zoning on the 200 block. That wasn't asked for
16 by them. That was an idea that the Mayor came
17 up with just throw that in.

18 So, I mean, that really affects our
19 quality of life. It's already noisy there. To
20 put a parking garage with lights and all that
21 stuff back there would be a really tough thing.
22 Why can't that be 45 feet? Why? I mean,
23 that's something we could address at a
24 different time, right?

25 Shouldn't the 200 block be taken

1 out? That's what I'm requesting. Please take
2 the 200 block out of this proposal. Thank you
3 for your time.

4 MR. SMURL: Thank you.

5 MS. O'MALLEY: Hello, Barb O'Malley,
6 Scranton resident. You know, I firmly believe
7 that engaged and informed citizens are the
8 bedrock of a democracy. Unfortunately, I think
9 we're all aware that our local newspaper is
10 greatly diminished.

11 So in terms of getting information
12 out in this compact timeframe and getting our
13 positions out, there's not even time to write a
14 letter to the editor. And you don't even know
15 if it's going to be published.

16 I mean, let's be honest, there's
17 letters from all over the place. You know, I
18 used to -- that was one way that I would
19 express my ideas, my concerns was through a
20 letter to the editor. It's not possible
21 anymore to get that information out.

22 We don't have coverage of the
23 meetings like we did in the past which benefits
24 all of us, no matter what your position, you
25 get your ideas out. It must be demoralizing

1 for our local journalist to have to watch ECTV
2 and write a report about a meeting on it if
3 they're assigned to it.

4 So with that background, I'm just
5 here to refer folks who might be watching and
6 want more information about the neighbors and
7 the process and what we're concerned about to
8 social media. And we have created a Facebook
9 page called Nay Aug Park Area Residents that
10 explains and goes into a little bit more detail
11 who we are, what our concerns are.

12 Unfortunately, we had to create our
13 own website because we couldn't associate with
14 the Hill Neighborhood Association anymore. So
15 please don't look for information for us on
16 that. The current President of the Hill
17 Neighborhood Association in his comments on our
18 social media page referred to us as a bunch of
19 morons and other things. That's the nice
20 thing.

21 So I'm telling people to look -- we
22 are the Nay Aug Park Area Residents. Another
23 thing that I think needs to be clarified, I
24 don't know how many times we could say it, but
25 we are not against healthcare and expanding. I

1 know we've said this over and over but that
2 apparently is a narrative, not the people
3 from -- from Geisinger, the professionals that
4 were here but the employees.

5 We've -- we've been told, you know,
6 I've been told by friends of mine who work at
7 the hospital, that's the narrative that -- from
8 ER doctors on up that we, you know, there's a
9 problem in the ER, blame it on the neighbors.
10 We're only asking as my neighbors have for
11 fair treatment to, you know, a residential
12 area.

13 And whoever said shoehorned, that's
14 true. And adding more services and adding more
15 people I think Mr. King was following that
16 train of thought in terms of where that garage
17 is going to end up. I mean, that's all we're
18 asking.

19 I know last night Dave used a
20 visual. He said this is what it's going to
21 look like from my -- he has a beautiful home on
22 Arthur. This is what it's going to look like
23 when he was trying to look out, okay. 75 feet
24 is, you know, up to about here.

25 So we're only asking for fairness.

1 We aren't trying to impede the healthcare in
2 this neighborhood in this city at all. But we
3 are not -- we are not a bunch of morons. And
4 we are not crybabies. And we're not all of
5 those other names that we've been referred to.

6 So once again, Nay Aug Park Area
7 Residents, if you want to hear a little bit
8 more about us if you want to expand your
9 knowledge, so thank you.

10 MR. SMURL: Thank you.

11 MR. COYNE: Tom Coyne, Minooka. One
12 of the things that was interesting me is today
13 trying to get here. The roads in my area were
14 pretty much unplowed. It got skimmed over
15 once. We have no salt on our roadway. My
16 tires in front of my house were slipping.
17 Sidewalks are not cleared.

18 There is slush outside of City Hall.
19 There was a fire truck blocking off the block
20 coming here as well. Why was there an urgency
21 to have citizens come in here and risk a fall,
22 a slip or an accident? Why is public safety of
23 going -- we just got hit with a bunch of
24 snowstorm -- snowstorm.

25 It's going to ice tonight and maybe

1 we shouldn't have this meeting because we are
2 bringing people out to talk in a hazardous
3 situation. We know why that is. We have a
4 limited time to pass it.

5 And those few days preclude shutting
6 down City Hall, risking City Hall workers who
7 work here and keeping it open so this could go
8 on so because this is what the Mayor wanted.

9 You're willing to risk the people
10 who come to the meeting and city employees for
11 an agenda for the Mayor. That's a serious
12 problem. How's code blue going considering
13 there's snow on the ground and we're freezing
14 out there?

15 All the shelters are open including
16 Weston Field, right? Now, I guess five months
17 wasn't long enough. And we'll still wait until
18 after that. And if they freeze to death, we'll
19 go, we're sorry. You had a few beds. I
20 brought peanut butter tonight to donate because
21 tonight is a sticky situation.

22 We looked at the pictures, the
23 plans. They said they're fictional. They're
24 an idea of what we might want there. They're
25 not actual plans.

1 It's a beautiful picture that was
2 drawn up to show something for a plan and a
3 concept that they don't have. They want a plan
4 here, let's show them something. They agreed
5 that it was fictional and it was not the actual
6 footprint and the plans.

7 So I'm not sure how we can base
8 anything on fictional nonexistent plans.
9 Zoning variances go along with the property.
10 And when they are transferred, zoning variances
11 die. Unlike this, it doesn't end with the
12 property. If the property ever gets exchanged,
13 it's still civic zone and it still goes on no
14 matter who owns it.

15 Their word here is useless. They
16 have it on the record, but it's not legal and
17 binding. The only legal and binding way is
18 when they go through zoning, get the variance;
19 and the variance limits them to a specific
20 height. Other than that, it has no value.

21 Now, A-3 lists a 4-1 vote. The
22 board itself is a five member board. Two out
23 of those board members aren't eligible to
24 participate because they haven't put in their
25 financial documents.

1 So two out of the five people are
2 not allowed to participate in the board. Hear,
3 judge, talk about; but they were still here for
4 this whole thing for the Planning Commission
5 and they voted on it. And the last time we
6 were there for the same exact thing, at the
7 very last meeting I called out Hinton because
8 he had a conflict of interest -- a direct
9 conflict and he stepped out.

10 But this time we have two board
11 members who have direct conflict of interest
12 who recused themselves last time who voted on
13 this to come forward. I think that's a serious
14 problem in the whole process of getting it here
15 when there is violations.

16 And the building next door, it's
17 been struck down multiple times, the financing
18 for it. We're buying a property that two or
19 three times has come before it including in
20 budgets where we've said we don't want it. Yet
21 somehow no is not no with this city.

22 Somehow no is not no when the Mayor
23 wants something done and the decision of this
24 board isn't final because every time that the
25 Mayor wants something, she gets it. And here's

1 your donations.

2 MR. SMURL: I believe that's it, Mr.
3 Voldenberg -- oh, no.

4 MR. LITTLE: Hello, Scranton, I'm
5 Rik Little. My mother would have been a 103
6 today. She died of cancer. I knew about it
7 seven years before. And she died when I was in
8 my first semester at college.

9 But since then I found out she
10 really died of chemo. And I'll tell you, I
11 broke my leg in 2017. That's when I started
12 growing my beard. I lived in Scranton public
13 housing on Adams Avenue. There was an army of
14 social workers who were just trying to get me
15 out of there.

16 I'm at Abington Manor. I'm riding
17 around in a wheelchair trying to fight these
18 people, couldn't get into City Hall. You know,
19 so that makes it, you know, that's a good
20 argument that the new -- the old Fidelity bank,
21 the old times -- the old -- what is it,
22 Scranton Tribune building next door is coming
23 up to expand on this.

24 But it doesn't make sense to me. I
25 think back to my talks with Tommy Culkin when

1 the whole government was run out of this
2 building and the fire department and the police
3 department and then the Civil War Museum.

4 And that's when the population is
5 much more than it is now. But I've always been
6 a constitutionalist in my upbringing. And I
7 remember, you know, in the big part of the
8 government and I'm talking about the deep
9 state. I'm talking about the old Department of
10 Defense, you know, where they -- the Pentagon
11 where they shot a missile into the exact place
12 where all the records were, financial records
13 and double insurance claims on everything.

14 But it just makes sense to me that,
15 you know, as it is above coming down. But when
16 you get to the county and city level, the whole
17 idea of the, you know, the charter is to make
18 things more convenient and easier for things.
19 And that's where things really get messed up,
20 especially the judiciary. And they do all
21 their tricks right before Thanksgiving and
22 Christmas and everything.

23 Everything is pushed in. And I see
24 that happening here pushing through stuff. And
25 it's just no one knows anything that's going

1 on. Everything in the paper -- most, you know,
2 I'd say 96 percent of it is outside globalist
3 forces, Associated Press, you know, all of
4 these other newspapers.

5 And I agree with the women who said,
6 you know, you can't get a letter to the paper.
7 And then there's the television. There has to
8 be discussion with people to have a democracy.
9 And it's just announced that this building the
10 Mayor wants to buy before she goes onto
11 Congress is 185 million dollars.

12 And I'm just wondering who
13 negotiated that price to buy that? That's just
14 it. It's 185 million dollars. And I don't
15 think -- I think 185 million dollars could be
16 used for a lot of things around Scranton
17 besides that.

18 MR. MCANDREW: It's 1.85.

19 MR. LITTLE: Well, I didn't hear
20 what you said. But I think, you know, since we
21 have this Lackawanna County assessment where
22 they tell you how much the building is worth,
23 maybe we should look at it because I've heard
24 rumors that, you know, the price of that
25 Fidelity Bank at 338 North Washington is about

1 half of that.

2 Maybe I'm wrong; but, you know, it's
3 just all coming in so fast at the holidays and
4 that's what the judiciary does and, you know.
5 And that's what the media does before any
6 election. And we got to slow down because this
7 is our city.

8 And when I say our, I mean all the
9 people. They should know what's going on.
10 Thanks.

11 MR. SMURL: Thank you.

12 MR. VOLDENBERG: FIFTH ORDER. 5-A.
13 MOTIONS.

14 MR. SMURL: Mr. King, do you have
15 any motions or comments?

16 MR. KING: Nothing at this time.

17 MR. SMURL: Mr. Schuster, do you
18 have any motions or comments?

19 MR. SCHUSTER: Yeah, just two. I
20 just want to remind the public that next week
21 on the 9th is going to be the public hearing
22 for Geisinger. We've had a lot of people come
23 in and speak their mind on it over the last two
24 to three weeks. And just remember that next
25 Tuesday is that public hearing and make sure to

1 come out on that day as well.

2 I had asked about an update with
3 Jackson Street. Did we get any kind of update
4 on Jackson? I didn't see any e-mails or
5 anything that came out about paving.

6 MR. VOLDENBERG: That was not on the
7 2025 paving list. But we're placing it on the
8 2026. They asked if we could have the specific
9 blocks that need repair and they'll --

10 MR. SCHUSTER: Well, this is with
11 the project that's being done there right now.
12 So I know there's mill -- it was scheduled to
13 be milled I think today was the date for Sumner
14 and Jackson. But we're cutting it close here
15 with the asphalt plants closing. I didn't know
16 if they were going to keep it like that through
17 the winter.

18 MR. VOLDENBERG: I'll ask about that
19 intersection.

20 MR. SCHUSTER: All right. Thank
21 you. Can we also send some correspondence to
22 the county to see what the Fidelity building
23 was assessed at?

24 MR. VOLDENBERG: I will, sir.

25 MR. SCHUSTER: All right. Thank

1 you. That's it.

2 MR. SMURL: Thank you, Mr. Schuster.
3 Dr. Rothchild, do you have any motions or
4 comments?

5 DR. ROTHCHILD: Yes, first, I wanted
6 to answer the questions about the unsheltered
7 task force meeting that Mr. Mancini has been
8 asking about. The last meeting we had was
9 October 15th. The Mayor calls those meetings
10 to order. And I've not received invitation or
11 notification of another upcoming meeting.

12 I will inquire if there has been one
13 set yet. But I do receive those invitations.
14 So there's not been another one that I'm aware
15 of. However, I know there were working on
16 figuring out the Code Blue Shelter and getting
17 someone to be able to take over that with staff
18 which Catholic Social Services was able to do.

19 And I received notification that a
20 position is opened on the Catholic Social
21 Services website as of November 5th. And I
22 have been told that someone was hired and
23 trained. And obviously that could take time
24 because we need to allow time for interviews
25 for the hiring process, for background checks,

1 all of those things that go into employment and
2 then the training too. So I understand why it
3 wasn't opened November 6th.

4 But I received word that it should
5 be -- let's see -- that they should be ready on
6 Thursday. So if there is overflow from St.
7 Anthony's which has not yet been at capacity,
8 then -- as of Thursday we should be able to
9 staff the Code Blue Shelter at Weston Field.
10 So that is the update there.

11 I also just want to point out too I
12 know in the past it was asked about those
13 unsheltered task force meetings if they were
14 open to the public. And I had inquired about
15 that. And we were told that that they were
16 not. And that was also at the Mayor's
17 discretion.

18 So to my knowledge, they are still
19 not being made public. But I could certainly
20 check again if that's an interest of the
21 Mayor's. But it hasn't seemed to be the case.
22 So I'm not sure if the questions about it were
23 so that the public could attend. So I just
24 wanted to point that out.

25 And I still have a lot of thoughts

1 regarding the caucus that we had tonight with
2 Geisinger and then the continued feedback that
3 we've been getting from neighbors and people
4 within the community. I will say that I -- I
5 understand -- I understand that there's a bit
6 more of an urgency because of what's going on
7 with Commonwealth and that makes me very
8 nervous as well.

9 I can't speak to as to why it didn't
10 come to us sooner. But I believe that's the
11 case for it being something that urgently needs
12 to be addressed now. But I do know there needs
13 to be a lot considered in the planning process
14 when it comes to some of the issues that were
15 brought tonight like traffic and lighting.

16 And there was comment tonight that
17 none of us up here have any clue or
18 understanding about quality healthcare. I'm a
19 healthcare provider. I provide healthcare on a
20 daily basis, sometimes six days a week. And I
21 believe that I give good quality healthcare to
22 my patients. That's what I strive for every
23 day -- actually not even good, but excellent
24 quality healthcare.

25 And, I mean, that's what I want for

1 myself and my family members as well. So I'm
2 not sure why that speaker was assuming that.
3 And I think that Geisinger does give good
4 quality healthcare in a lot of ways. But I
5 think they are also constrained. And from what
6 they've explained tonight that they're maxed
7 out in terms of their space.

8 And there's a lot of uncertainty
9 ahead. And we want to -- all of us have said
10 that we're coming from a place where we want
11 there to be that access to healthcare within
12 the City of Scranton. So I'm glad we're all on
13 the same page about that. That's all that I
14 have. Thank you.

15 MR. SMURL: Thank you, Dr.
16 Rothchild. Mr. McAndrew, do you have any
17 motions or comments?

18 MR. MCANDREW: All I have right now
19 is 409 Lackawanna Avenue would like to have a
20 15 minute loading zoning -- loading zone sign
21 in front of their -- I'm sorry, a 15 minute
22 loading zone in front for delivery just like
23 the 200 Adams Avenue has on their front. If I
24 could say that again.

25 MR. VOLDENBERG: I'll submit it,

1 sir.

2 MR. MCANDREW: You know, where I'm
3 coming from, all right?

4 MR. VOLDENBERG: Yes, I have the
5 number.

6 MR. MCANDREW: All right. Thank
7 you. That's all I have of.

8 MR. SMURL: Thank you. Last week we
9 had a concern about unsheltered members of the
10 community and what the city policy is on the
11 encampments in the area and the police
12 department and DPW taking down the camps.

13 The response we received was
14 Scranton Police Department routinely
15 investigates the crime trespass involving
16 unauthorized individuals with tents on property
17 of another.

18 When such a site is identified,
19 officers provide notice of the violation in the
20 following ways:

21 Verbal notification to the occupants
22 if present and placement of a special purpose
23 Scranton Police Department sign that says no
24 trespassing. It's a yard sign that we've used
25 in the past. Both methods are served as formal

1 48 hours notice to vacate the premises.

2 The police make every effort to
3 educate everyone and refer individuals to
4 appropriate community based services and
5 support resources. After the 48 hour notice
6 period has elapsed, Scranton Police Department
7 returns to the location to ensure compliance
8 with the lawful order.

9 In most cases, the site is vacated
10 prior to the police department's return.
11 However, it is not uncommon for officers to
12 find abandoned personal belongings, trash and
13 biohazardous material left behind.

14 Once the police department confirms
15 no items of value are personally identifiable
16 or value property remain, the department may
17 request assistance on proper equipment from
18 Department of Public Works and safely tear the
19 site down in the interest of public health and
20 safety. And that's the administration's
21 response for the encampments. Frank.

22 MR. VOLDENBERG: 5-B.

23 MR. SCHUSTER: Sorry, can I say one
24 more thing? And this may also be for
25 Mr. Gilbride as well. Can we reach out to the

1 Law Department whether it be Andrew Cutillo or
2 Jessica Eskra, I know Mr. Cutillo's been
3 working on this. See if there's any appetite
4 there for a community benefits agreement with
5 the hospital and with the neighbors.

6 MR. VOLDENBERG: We will.

7 MR. SCHUSTER: Thank you.

8 MR. VOLDENBERG: 5-B. FOR
9 INTRODUCTION AN ORDINANCE - LEVYING THE
10 PROPERTY TAX MILLAGE FOR THE YEAR 2026.

11 MR. SMURL: At this time I'll
12 entertain a motion that Item 5-B be introduced
13 into its proper committee.

14 MR. MCANDREW: So moved.

15 MR. KING: Second.

16 MR. SMURL: On the question? All
17 those in favor of introduction signify by
18 saying aye.

19 MR. KING: Aye.

20 MR. SCHUSTER: Aye.

21 DR. ROTHCHILD: Aye.

22 MR. MCANDREW: Aye.

23 MR. SMURL: Aye. Opposed? The ayes
24 have it and so moved.

25 MR. VOLDENBERG: 5-C. FOR

1 INTRODUCTION - AN ORDINANCE - AMENDING
2 PROVISIONS OF PARKING OR STANDING OF TRUCKS IN
3 RESIDENCE DISTRICTS (ARTICLE XII, CHAPTER 439)
4 TO REGULATE THE PARKING OF DETACHED
5 SEMITRAILERS ON PUBLIC STREETS WITHIN THE CITY
6 OF SCRANTON.

7 MR. SMURL: At this time I'll
8 entertain a motion that Item 5-C be introduced
9 into its proper committee.

10 MR. MCANDREW: So moved.

11 MR. SCHUSTER: Second.

12 MR. KING: Second.

13 MR. SMURL: On the question? All
14 those in favor of introduction signify by
15 saying aye.

16 MR. KING: Aye.

17 MR. SCHUSTER: Aye.

18 DR. ROTHCHILD: Aye.

19 MR. MCANDREW: Aye.

20 MR. SMURL: Aye. Opposed? The ayes
21 have it and so moved.

22 MR. VOLDENBERG: 5-D. FOR
23 INTRODUCTION - AN ORDINANCE - AMENDING
24 ADMINISTRATIVE PROVISIONS OF THE ARCHITECTURAL
25 AND URBAN DESIGN REVIEW COMMISSION (CHAPTER 18,

1 ARTICLE VII OF CITY CODE) TO IMPROVE
2 IMPLEMENTATION.

3 MR. SMURL: At this time I'll
4 entertain a motion that Item 5-D be introduced
5 into its proper committee.

6 MR. MCANDREW: So moved.

7 DR. ROTHCHILD: Second.

8 MR. SMURL: On the question? All
9 those in favor of introduction signify by
10 saying aye.

11 MR. KING: Aye.

12 MR. SCHUSTER: Aye.

13 DR. ROTHCHILD: Aye.

14 MR. MCANDREW: Aye.

15 MR. SMURL: Aye. Opposed? The ayes
16 have it and so moved.

17 MR. VOLDENBERG: 5-E. FOR
18 INTRODUCTION - AN ORDINANCE - AMENDING FILE OF
19 THE COUNCIL NO. 31, 2024, AN ORDINANCE, AS
20 AMENDED, ENTITLED "APPROVING AND ACCEPTING THE
21 CITY OF SCRANTON CAPITAL BUDGET, WHICH INCLUDES
22 A CAPITAL RESERVE FUND SPENDING PLAN, FOR THE
23 YEAR 2025 PURSUANT TO SECTION 904 OF THE CITY'S
24 HOME RULE CHARTER AND FILE OF COUNCIL NO. 11 OF
25 2024," BY ADDING A NEW LINE ITEM IN THE 2025

1 CAPITAL BUDGET AND IN THE 2025 CAPITAL RESERVE
2 FUND SPENDING PLAN FOR THE DOWN PAYMENT TOWARD
3 THE PURCHASE OF PROPERTY LOCATED AT 334-336
4 NORTH WASHINGTON AVENUE IN SCRANTON, PA.

5 MR. SMURL: At this time I'll
6 entertain a motion that Item 5-E be introduced
7 into its proper committee.

8 MR. KING: So moved.

9 DR. ROTHCHILD: Second.

10 MR. SMURL: On the question?

11 MR. SCHUSTER: On the question,
12 there's a couple things I'm going to say about
13 two of the items on the agenda tonight. And
14 I'll save -- I'll save it for the next item
15 that's coming up.

16 MR. MCANDREW: On the question, on
17 the question, so we've been talking about
18 Geisinger -- not Geisinger -- listen to me --
19 Fidelity has been pushed towards us, the
20 purchase of it for, I don't know, three, four
21 years.

22 None of us had an appetite for it.
23 And then it appears itself in an amendment to
24 the capital budget of 2025. 2025 is over,
25 like, in a couple weeks. So out of nowhere,

1 this legislation comes. I could remember when
2 I was running for Council, I wasn't quite here
3 yet that there was great debate that they
4 should sell this building.

5 We got to sell City Hall, can't
6 afford to fix it. And you know what, it's too
7 big for us anymore. I remember that. And I'm
8 so glad that they -- you know, of course, they
9 didn't sell it and brought it to the beauty
10 that it is today.

11 And that took 4 million dollars
12 recently. All right. And this building -- so
13 then next door, they're looking at 1.85. To
14 me, that's 2 million dollars. You know, call
15 it whatever you want.

16 Of course I've always support public
17 safety in all of their initiatives. They have
18 a beautiful command center in their newer
19 building. They were here first. They're here
20 20 years.

21 And you know every mention the past
22 couple years buying the building next door
23 wasn't regarding public safety or putting a new
24 command center there because you have a fairly
25 new one down the street.

1 I've always been a guy there's need
2 to have, nice to have especially when I'm
3 spending taxpayers' money, especially. So do
4 we need to have that building next door? No.
5 Would it be nice to have for the Chief, sure.
6 But they'll still do a fantastic job with the
7 building they have and fighting crime.

8 And because the only other office
9 was going to be in there was code enforcement,
10 which -- so it's a three-story building. So
11 was there an appraisal? I don't know. There
12 was no conversation with regards to the
13 building next door with any of us.

14 I don't know about you guys if you
15 had any conversation with the Mayor. Was there
16 an appraisal? I don't know, you know? So
17 guess what, we're still recently out of Act 47.
18 The ARPA checkbook, all the checks have been
19 written, 68 million dollars gone.

20 But that 68 million dollars was
21 deposited next door. So they get -- when
22 Fidelity -- well, they're still there. That
23 was for them. So what are the remodeling costs
24 not mentioned in the article the other day?

25 What are the fixed and variable

1 expenses going to be, including heat, water,
2 electricity, security, technology, insurance?
3 No mention of that to us in the paper. The
4 residents would be paying for that obviously.

5 And like I said, three floors with
6 only two entities earmarked to use it. That's
7 a waste. There's also mention of a bridge
8 from here to city -- from City Hall to next
9 door. What's that going to cost because the
10 paper states that it's turnkey. I'm not buying
11 that one.

12 I want to know who made the offer?
13 Simple question. That wasn't brought to our
14 attention. Is it worth 1 point -- 2 million.
15 I'm rounding it up to 2 million. I don't think
16 so. There is no comprehension plan. We're
17 going to spend 2 million dollars for no
18 comprehensive plan presented to us.

19 Because, you know what, the Mayor
20 might not be here. She's planning on leaving,
21 so we're going to be left holding the bag. Us
22 and the taxpayers are going to have to pay for
23 this. So, you know, I'm not happy with this.

24 It's just another rush job in the
25 final weeks of December amending the 2025

1 capital budget. This isn't next year's budget.
2 All right. This money could be better spent on
3 the homeless we keep talking about and the
4 issue of code blue and nowhere to house them
5 anymore.

6 I mean, that would be a great place
7 to spend some of this money, right? Paving
8 roads that haven't made the list this year or
9 have never made the list we hear about all the
10 time. How about selling contracts? I mean,
11 there's a multitude of issues that present
12 themselves to us constantly here in chambers
13 where that money could be well spent.

14 We were not told how -- some of it's
15 going to be paid for grants next door and some
16 other funding sources. We're not told what
17 that is. Like I said earlier, 4 million was
18 used for City Hall renovations which was needed
19 and I supported like I said.

20 But nothing was done to make City
21 Hall more handicap accessible. I'm not an
22 architect, but in this day and age I'm sure
23 this could have been rectified but now claiming
24 the Fidelity building will be the answer to
25 handicap accessibility. It's going to be

1 easier for the handicapped.

2 Every resident should have the
3 access to City Hall, meaning, entering the
4 front and not having to utilize the one parking
5 spot in the alley with a ramp with no real
6 access to the building without a fob.

7 And also, City Hall historically was
8 able to conduct city business when the city's
9 population was close to double in size and did
10 not have the luxury of the technology we have
11 today.

12 So I still -- like I said, need to
13 have, nice to have. We don't need it. We
14 can't afford it. And also, the craziest part
15 of all of this was brought to my attention
16 today. Now it's been brought to my attention
17 that thousands of dollars in campaign donations
18 for multiple years have come from the Fidelity
19 board members to the Mayor and one of them
20 sharing her last name.

21 It's alarming, guys. And now the
22 Mayor wants to buy the building? Hey, anybody
23 can donate to any campaign. I have no problem
24 with that. But when you knowingly accept
25 campaign donations with the idea of purchasing

1 a building from donors who have direct ties to
2 the building is the problem I have with
3 taxpayer money.

4 If I was to vote yes, then I'm
5 voting yes and supporting a conflict and a
6 behavior that I'm uncomfortable with. And I
7 can't do this in good conscience for this
8 reason mainly and all the others I presented
9 before.

10 MR. SMURL: Thank you. Anyone else
11 on the question? All those in favor of
12 introduction signify by saying aye.

13 MR. KING: Aye.

14 DR. ROTHCHILD: Aye.

15 MR. SMURL: Aye. Opposed?

16 MR. SCHUSTER: No.

17 MR. MCANDREW: No.

18 MR. SMURL: The ayes have it and so
19 moved.

20 MR. VOLDENBERG: 5-G. FOR
21 INTRODUCTION - A RESOLUTION - AUTHORIZING THE
22 MAYOR AND OTHER APPROPRIATE CITY OFFICIALS TO
23 EXECUTE AND ENTER INTO A CONTRACT WITH KRIGER
24 CONSTRUCTION INC. TO PERFORM SERVICES FOR THE
25 BIDEN STREET STREETScape PROJECT.

1 MR. SMURL: At this time I'll
2 entertain a motion that Item 5-G be introduced
3 into its proper committee.

4 MR. MCANDREW: So moved.

5 MR. KING: So moved.

6 DR. ROTHCHILD: Second.

7 MR. SMURL: On the question? All
8 those in favor of introduction signify by
9 saying aye.

10 MR. KING: Aye.

11 MR. SCHUSTER: Aye.

12 DR. ROTHCHILD: Aye.

13 MR. MCANDREW: Aye.

14 MR. SMURL: Aye. Opposed? The ayes
15 have it and so moved.

16 MR. VOLDENBERG: 5-H. FOR
17 INTRODUCTION - A RESOLUTION - AUTHORIZING THE
18 MAYOR AND OTHER APPROPRIATE CITY OFFICIALS TO
19 EXECUTE AND ENTER INTO A CONTRACT WITH RLE
20 ENTERPRISES TO PERFORM SERVICES FOR THE EAST
21 MOUNTAIN STORMWATER IMPROVEMENTS (CONTRACT 2)
22 PROJECT.

23 MR. SMURL: At this time I'll
24 entertain a motion that Item 5-H be introduced
25 into its proper committee.

1 MR. KING: So moved.

2 DR. ROTHCHILD: Second.

3 MR. SMURL: On the question? All
4 those in favor of introduction signify by
5 saying aye.

6 MR. KING: Aye.

7 MR. SCHUSTER: Aye.

8 DR. ROTHCHILD: Aye.

9 MR. MCANDREW: Aye.

10 MR. SMURL: Aye. Opposed? The ayes
11 have it and so moved.

12 MR. VOLDENBERG: 5-I. FOR
13 INTRODUCTION - A RESOLUTION - AUTHORIZING THE
14 MAYOR AND OTHER APPROPRIATE CITY OFFICIALS TO
15 EXECUTE AND ENTER INTO ANY ALL DOCUMENTS
16 NECESSARY TO PURCHASE CERTAIN PORTIONS OF THE
17 PROPERTY SITUATED AT 334-336 NORTH WASHINGTON
18 AVENUE IN SCRANTON, PENNSYLVANIA (PARCEL
19 156.28-010-003).

20 MR. SMURL: At this time I'll
21 entertain a motion that Item 5-I be introduced
22 into its proper committee.

23 MR. KING: So moved.

24 DR. ROTHCHILD: Second.

25 MR. SMURL: On the question?

1 MR. SCHUSTER: On the question, so
2 I'm going to probably mirror some of the
3 comments from Mr. McAndrew. So some of the
4 information that I would love to see is has
5 there been an appraisal on this building. And
6 the one that I already asked previously was,
7 what's the recent county assessment for the
8 property.

9 I know it sold in 1998 for 720,000.
10 Is there a plan for parking for the public?
11 And last week we had a piece of legislation
12 that was asking to borrow up to 3 million
13 dollars for renovation. What are their
14 renovation projects that they have for that
15 building if they were to buy it?

16 We didn't get any kind of utilities
17 or operating costs. So does the administration
18 have an estimate on utilities and operating
19 costs? With those operating costs and the new
20 employees that we're going to add in this
21 year's budget, the expenditures are probably
22 about million dollars.

23 So this property will now come off
24 the tax rolls. Does the city know how much
25 taxes they are going to lose from this

1 building? So that's the question I have, Mr.
2 Voldenberg. So what does the city stand to
3 lose when it comes to taxes brought in from the
4 building as well as the county and the school
5 district?

6 So at this point in time we're going
7 to lose tax revenue. And we're going to add
8 expenditures. My fear here is that we enter
9 into something the like the county entered into
10 when they bought the Globe Store. We're
11 talking 1.8 or we can round it up to 2 million,
12 whatever you would like.

13 So 1.8 million plus a possible 3
14 million in renovations, plus questionable
15 operating costs, I fear going into next year
16 and the following year we're going to enter a
17 situation, like I said, as the county entered
18 into where the city is in debt, I don't know, 2
19 to 6 million dollars.

20 And as was said before, we have a
21 Mayor that may be leaving at that point in
22 time. Our ARPA money is gone. That's running
23 out. And recently we've had a lot of good --
24 we've had positive financial gains. The city
25 is operating within its footprint.

1 And I'm happy with the footprint
2 that we're operating into. But I don't think
3 it's time to expand out. I don't want it to
4 have a snowball affect on our budget. And I
5 don't want to see us in debt moving forward
6 into the future.

7 And that's why I'm going to be
8 voting against this. I've also expressed this
9 when it's popped in other capital budgets in
10 years past that I wasn't in favor of this when
11 it was -- when it was in those budgets -- in
12 those capital expenditure projects at the time.
13 I'll be voting against Item 5-I.

14 DR. ROTHCHILD: On the question, I
15 feel that there's been fair questions that have
16 been asked. And I would also like to see those
17 answers. I'll be voting to introduce this so
18 that we do allow for time to receive those
19 answers and for us to deliberate more on this
20 decision.

21 I know I had said a couple years ago
22 as well as several of my colleagues when it
23 came to this decision previously. We said,
24 well, let's take care of the house that we have
25 first. Let's renovate this building, which is

1 what we did. And I'm very happy with that
2 decision.

3 And now for this decision, I feel
4 like we do need more information. And I don't
5 believe I have any questions to add to what's
6 already been asked. But I would like to see
7 what -- some of that information that we
8 receive.

9 I am happy about the potential for
10 improved accessibility, handicapped
11 accessibility. I know that wasn't something
12 included in the renovations for this building.
13 I don't know how doable that would have been or
14 practical for this building, what the cost
15 would have entailed.

16 Or if this building is really set up
17 for that and for what's required today for ADA
18 accessibility. But I do know that that is
19 important for us to have for people to be able
20 to enter our buildings and use the buildings
21 and have the access with greater ease.

22 We have complaints about that in the
23 past. And I do take them seriously. And I
24 could see that being an advantage for this
25 space from what they've been told -- or what

1 we've been told. And I know that that during
2 one of the caucuses, it was explained to us a
3 bit about the crime center and the first floor
4 and what those would include.

5 I would also like to ask what the
6 plans are for the third floor and then for the
7 appraisal information too. That's all that I
8 have.

9 MR. KING: On the question, I would
10 be interested in hearing the answers to
11 Mr. Schuster's questions as well. That's all.

12 MR. MCANDREW: On the question, I
13 mean, need to have, nice to have. And now
14 after hearing all of the other stuff that very
15 concerns me the most, we deposited the ARPA
16 money next door.

17 They got a five million grant from
18 us. And now they're going to get almost 2
19 million dollars from us. I know they had
20 trouble securing finance buying the beautiful
21 Electric City Building. But how much is enough
22 from us or the taxpayers, especially with the
23 money going back and forth.

24 That's -- that's enough for me in
25 good conscience, I can't. That's -- that's not

1 how it works, guys. That's not how it's
2 supposed to happen. Campaign contributions and
3 favours that are returned is not what we do
4 here. I won't be part of that. I won't --
5 there's no yes for that for me. I vote yes,
6 then I agree with it. I don't.

7 DR. ROTHCHILD: I don't -- I don't
8 see why they would need for us to be the ones
9 to be the buyers. Like, I think we have more
10 advantage on that than they do. Like, they
11 could find other buyers for the property,
12 especially if it is turnkey and in good
13 condition.

14 So I'm not totally seeing where the
15 conflict is. I also am happy to see someone in
16 the Electric Life Building and to have the
17 presence there and for Fidelity to be bringing
18 in all of their employees to the city, and I
19 don't have any donations from them. So
20 that's what --

21 MR. MCANDREW: The conflict lies
22 that she is making the proposal. It's her idea
23 to sell it, not ours. That's the conflict
24 after receiving campaign -- I'm sorry, it
25 doesn't sound -- I have a bad appetite for

1 that. It doesn't sit well with me.

2 MR. SMURL: Thank you. All those in
3 favor of introduction signify by saying aye.

4 MR. KING: Aye.

5 DR. ROTHCHILD: Aye.

6 MR. MCANDREW: Aye.

7 MR. SMURL: Aye. Opposed?

8 MR. SCHUSTER: No.

9 MR. SMURL: The ayes have it and so
10 moved.

11 MR. VOLDENBERG: SIXTH ORDER.

12 6-A. READING BY TITLE - FILE OF THE
13 COUNCIL NO. 106, 2025 - AN ORDINANCE -
14 TRANSFERRING FUNDS FROM, CLOSING AND ABOLISHING
15 INACTIVE SPECIAL CITY ACCOUNTS; AMENDING
16 ACCOUNT 120-29541-000-000-000000; AND CREATING
17 AND ESTABLISHING A NEW ACCOUNT
18 120-29643-000-000-000000 FOR THE DEPARTMENT OF
19 PARKS AND RECREATION TO RECEIVE AND DISBURSE
20 DONATIONS TO ALL CITY PARKS.

21 MR. SMURL: You've heard reading by
22 title of Item 6-A. What is your pleasure?

23 MR. MCANDREW: Mr. Chairman, I move
24 that Item 6-A pass reading by title.

25 MR. KING: Second.

1 MR. SMURL: On the question? All
2 those in favor signify by saying aye.

3 MR. KING: Aye.

4 MR. SCHUSTER: Aye.

5 DR. ROTHCHILD: Aye.

6 MR. MCANDREW: Aye.

7 MR. SMURL: Aye. Opposed? The ayes
8 have it and so moved.

9 MR. VOLDENBERG: SEVENTH ORDER.

10 7-A. FOR CONSIDERATION BY THE
11 COMMITTEE ON FINANCE - FOR ADOPTION - FILE OF
12 THE COUNCIL NO. 105, 2025 - AMENDING THE
13 INVESTMENT POLICY FOR THE CITY OF SCRANTON.

14 MR. SMURL: What is the
15 recommendation of the Chairperson for the
16 Committee on Finance?

17 MR. KING: As Chairperson for the
18 Committee on Finance, I recommend final passage
19 of Item 7-A.

20 DR. ROTHCHILD: Second.

21 MR. SMURL: On the question? Roll
22 call, please.

23 MS. CARRERA: Mr. King.

24 MR. KING: Yes.

25 MS. CARRERA: Mr. Schuster.

1 MR. SCHUSTER: Yes.

2 MS. CARRERA: Dr. Rothchild.

3 DR. ROTHCHILD: Yes.

4 MS. CARRERA: Mr. McAndrew.

5 MR. MCANDREW: Yes.

6 MS. CARRERA: Mr. Smurl.

7 MR. SMURL: Yes. I hereby declare

8 Item 7-A legally and lawfully adopted.

9 MR. VOLDENBERG: 7-B. FOR
10 CONSIDERATION BY THE COMMITTEE ON PUBLIC
11 WORKS - FOR ADOPTION - RESOLUTION NO. 304,
12 2025 - ACCEPTING A DONATION IN THE AMOUNT OF
13 TEN THOUSAND DOLLARS (\$10,000.00) TO THE CITY
14 OF SCRANTON'S PARKS AND RECREATION DEPARTMENT
15 TO BE PLACED IN THE SPECIAL CITY SERVICES
16 ACCOUNT: 120-29643-000-000-000000.

17 MR. SMURL: What is the
18 recommendation of the Chairperson for the
19 Committee on Public Works?

20 MR. SCHUSTER: As Chairperson for
21 the Committee on Public Works, I recommend
22 final passage of Item 7-B.

23 MR. KING: Second.

24 MR. SMURL: On the question? Roll
25 call, please.

1 MS. CARRERA: Mr. King.

2 MR. KING: Yes.

3 MS. CARRERA: Mr. Schuster.

4 MR. SCHUSTER: Yes.

5 MS. CARRERA: Dr. Rothchild.

6 DR. ROTHCHILD: Yes.

7 MS. CARRERA: Mr. McAndrew.

8 MR. MCANDREW: Yes.

9 MS. CARRERA: Mr. Smurl.

10 MR. SMURL: Yes. I hereby declare
11 Item 7-B legally and lawfully adopted.

12 MR. VOLDENBERG: 7-C. FOR
13 CONSIDERATION BY THE COMMITTEE ON COMMUNITY
14 DEVELOPMENT - FOR ADOPTION - RESOLUTION NO.
15 305, 2025 - AUTHORIZING THE MAYOR AND OTHER
16 APPROPRIATE CITY OFFICIALS TO EXECUTE AND
17 SUBMIT A GRANT APPLICATION BY THE OFFICE OF
18 ECONOMIC AND COMMUNITY DEVELOPMENT OF THE CITY
19 OF SCRANTON TO THE COMMONWEALTH OF PENNSYLVANIA
20 ACTING THROUGH THE COMMONWEALTH FINANCING
21 AUTHORITY FOR A LOCAL SHARE ACCOUNT GRANT, FOR
22 UP TO \$141,678.00 TO BE USED TOWARDS THE TRIPP
23 PARK MISS-E LEAGUE FENCING REPLACEMENT PROJECT.

24 MR. SMURL: What is the
25 recommendation of the Chairperson for the

1 Committee on Community Development?

2 DR. ROTHCHILD: As Chairperson for
3 the Committee on Community Development, I
4 recommend final passage of Item 7-C.

5 MR. KING: Second.

6 MR. SMURL: On the question? Roll
7 call, please.

8 MS. CARRERA: Mr. King.

9 MR. KING: Yes.

10 MS. CARRERA: Mr. Schuster.

11 MR. SCHUSTER: Yes.

12 MS. CARRERA: Dr. Rothchild.

13 DR. ROTHCHILD: Yes.

14 MS. CARRERA: Mr. McAndrew.

15 MR. MCANDREW: Yes.

16 MS. CARRERA: Mr. Smurl.

17 MR. SMURL: Yes. I hereby declare
18 Item 7-C legally and lawfully adopted.

19 MR. VOLDENBERG: 7-D. FOR
20 CONSIDERATION BY THE COMMITTEE ON PUBLIC
21 WORKS - FOR ADOPTION - RESOLUTION NO. 306,
22 2025 - AUTHORIZING THE MAYOR AND OTHER
23 APPROPRIATE CITY OFFICIALS TO EXECUTE AND ENTER
24 INTO A CONTRACT WITH KRIGER CONSTRUCTION, INC.
25 TO PERFORM SERVICES FOR THE WYOMING AVENUE

1 STREETSCAPE PROJECT.

2 MR. SMURL: What is the
3 recommendation of the Chairperson for the
4 Committee on Public Works?

5 MR. SCHUSTER: As Chairperson for
6 the Committee on Public Works, I recommend
7 final passage of Item 7-D.

8 DR. ROTHCHILD: Second.

9 MR. SMURL: On the question? Roll
10 call, please.

11 MS. CARRERA: Mr. King.

12 MR. KING: Yes.

13 MS. CARRERA: Mr. Schuster.

14 MR. SCHUSTER: Yes.

15 MS. CARRERA: Dr. Rothchild.

16 DR. ROTHCHILD: Yes.

17 MS. CARRERA: Mr. McAndrew.

18 MR. MCANDREW: Yes.

19 MS. CARRERA: Mr. Smurl.

20 MR. SMURL: Yes. I hereby declare
21 Item 7-D legally and lawfully adopted.

22 MR. VOLDENBERG: 7-E. FOR
23 CONSIDERATION BY THE COMMITTEE ON PUBLIC WORKS
24 - FOR ADOPTION - RESOLUTION NO. 308, 2025 -
25 AUTHORIZING THE MAYOR AND OTHER APPROPRIATE

1 CITY OFFICIALS TO EXECUTE AND ENTER INTO A
2 CONTRACT WITH KRIGER CONSTRUCTION, INC. TO
3 PERFORM SERVICES FOR THE LINDEN STREET/NORTH
4 WASHINGTON AVENUE STREETScape PROJECT.

5 MR. SMURL: What is the
6 recommendation of the Chairperson for the
7 Committee on Public Works?

8 MR. SCHUSTER: As Chairperson for
9 the Committee on Public Works, I recommend
10 final passage of Item 7-E.

11 MR. KING: Second.

12 MR. SMURL: On the question? Roll
13 call, please.

14 MS. CARRERA: Mr. King.

15 MR. KING: Yes.

16 MS. CARRERA: Mr. Schuster.

17 MR. SCHUSTER: Yes.

18 MS. CARRERA: Dr. Rothchild.

19 DR. ROTHCHILD: Yes.

20 MS. CARRERA: Mr. McAndrew.

21 MR. MCANDREW: Yes.

22 MS. CARRERA: Mr. Smurl.

23 MR. SMURL: Yes. I hereby declare
24 Item 7-E legally and lawfully adopted.

25 MR. VOLDENBERG: 7-F. FOR

1 CONSIDERATION BY THE COMMITTEE ON PUBLIC
2 WORKS - FOR ADOPTION - RESOLUTION NO. 309,
3 2025 - AUTHORIZING THE MAYOR AND OTHER
4 APPROPRIATE CITY OFFICIALS TO EXECUTE AND ENTER
5 INTO A CONTRACT WITH AMERICAN ASPHALT PAVING
6 COMPANY TO PERFORM SERVICES FOR THE ADAMS
7 AVENUE STREETScape PROJECT.

8 MR. SMURL: What is the
9 recommendation of the Chairperson for the
10 Committee on Public Works?

11 MR. SCHUSTER: As Chairperson for
12 the Committee on Public Works, I recommend
13 final passage of Item 7-F.

14 MR. KING: Second.

15 MR. SMURL: On the question? Roll
16 call, please.

17 MS. CARRERA: Mr. King.

18 MR. KING: Yes.

19 MS. CARRERA: Mr. Schuster.

20 MR. SCHUSTER: Yes.

21 MS. CARRERA: Dr. Rothchild.

22 DR. ROTHCHILD: Yes.

23 MS. CARRERA: Mr. McAndrew.

24 MR. MCANDREW: Yes.

25 MS. CARRERA: Mr. Smurl.

1 MR. SMURL: Yes. I hereby declare
2 Item 7-F legally and lawfully adopted.

3 MR. VOLDENBERG: EIGHTH ORDER.

4 8 A. FILE OF COUNCIL NO. 102, 2025.

5 MR. SMURL: This ordinance was taken
6 from the table and placed in Seventh Order for
7 a final vote this evening.

8 MR. VOLDENBERG: 8-B. RESOLUTION
9 NO. 301, 2025.

10 MR. SMURL: This resolution is
11 appointment of Anna Campbell to the Board of
12 Scranton Authority for a five-year term. It
13 has been tabled pending further review.

14 MR. VOLDENBERG: 8-C. FILE OF THE
15 COUNCIL NO. 104, 2025.

16 MR. SMURL: This is the amendment to
17 the zoning ordinance. It has been tabled until
18 Council could meet with officials from
19 Geisinger this evening and also until a public
20 hearing to be held on Tuesday, December 9 at
21 5:45 p.m.

22 MR. VOLDENBERG: 8-D. Resolution
23 No. 307, 2025.

24 MR. SMURL: This resolution is the
25 HARB denial of the installation of a furnace --

1 or a fence at 301-303 Penn Avenue. It has been
2 tabled until further public hearing can be held
3 and it will be moved to next week.

4 MR. VOLDENBERG: 8-E. Resolution
5 No. 299 of 2025.

6 MR. SMURL: This is a reappointment
7 of Melinda Krokus as an alternate member of the
8 Environmental Advisory Council for a three-year
9 term. It has been tabled pending further
10 review.

11 ATTY. GILBRIDE: Before you close
12 the meeting, 8-A was not removed from the
13 table. It stayed on the table today. It will
14 be removed next week for consideration.

15 MR. SMURL: Okay. Is that fine with
16 that, Attorney Gilbride, or do you want me to
17 restate it or that's fine?

18 ATTY. GILBRIDE: No, I think
19 you're --

20 MR. SMURL: Okay. Thank you. If
21 there's no further business, I'll entertain a
22 motion to adjourn.

23 MR. MCANDREW: Motion to adjourn.

24 MR. SMURL: Thank you. This meeting
25 is adjourned.

C E R T I F I C A T E

I hereby certify that the proceedings and evidence are contained fully and accurately in the notes taken by me of the above-cause and that this copy is a correct transcript of the same to the best of my ability.

A handwritten signature in cursive script that reads "Maria McCool".

Maria McCool, RPR
Official Court Reporter

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